

INVESTING IN PEOPLE

Youth development is another major area of municipal relevance. Government has highlighted the need to build a pipeline of young artisans, engineers, town planners and technical professionals who can support local government infrastructure delivery.

Environmental capacity is also becoming important at municipal level. The Municipal Environmental Graduates Programme, launched in 2025, initially placed 430 environmental graduates in municipalities for a 24-month period to respond to youth unemployment and strengthen environmental capacity in local government.

Community upliftment programmes should not be seen as charity. They are investments in local resilience. When residents gain skills, income, experience and access to opportunities, communities become stronger. When municipalities work with civil society, businesses and provincial departments, upliftment programmes can become pathways to employment, entrepreneurship and long-term social stability.



KEY FOCUS AREAS

- Community Work Programme
- Skills development
- Enterprise creation
- Youth technical pipeline
- Environmental graduates
- Sustainable livelihoods



WHY IT MATTERS

- Strong communities are built on jobs, skills and opportunity.
- Investing in people today creates lasting local resilience and long-term.